

Southern Greens

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Here's a basic recipe for southern fried greens, specifically collard greens, based on several sources:

Ingredients

- Fresh collard greens (approx. 1.5 - 2 lbs)
- Thick-cut bacon (approx. 5-6 slices, chopped)
- Onion (1 small or ½ large, finely diced)
- Garlic (2-3 cloves, minced)
- Chicken broth (approx. 4 cups)
- Water (approx. 2 cups)
- Smoked ham hock or smoked turkey leg (optional, for added flavor)
- Sugar (1-2 tablespoons)
- Salt (approx. 1 teaspoon, plus more to taste)
- Black pepper (approx. ½ teaspoon)
- Red pepper flakes (½ teaspoon, optional, for heat)
- Apple cider vinegar (2 tablespoons)
- Hot sauce (optional, for serving)

Instructions

To prepare southern fried greens, first wash and chop the greens, removing the stems. Cook bacon in a pot until crispy, then set aside the bacon and leave the drippings. Sauté diced onion in the drippings until soft, then add minced garlic. Add the collard greens to the pot and stir until slightly wilted. Pour in chicken broth and water, and add the ham hock (if using), sugar, salt, pepper, and red pepper flakes. Bring the mixture to a simmer, cover, and cook on low heat for 1.5 to 2 hours until the greens are tender, stirring occasionally. Finally, stir in the apple cider vinegar and crumbled bacon. Adjust seasonings as needed. Serve hot with hot sauce if desired, often alongside cornbread.

Variations

- For a vegetarian or vegan option, use olive oil or vegetable broth and omit the bacon and ham hock. Liquid smoke can add a smoky flavor.
- Increase the red pepper flakes or add jalapeno for more heat.